

QUALITY ASSURANCE SURVEILLANCE PLAN (QASP)

**Department of Justice (DOJ)
Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives (ATF)
Field Operations (FO)
Special Operations Division (SOD)**

ATF Mass Notification System

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Solicitation/Contract/Task Order *<Insert Number>*

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QUALITY ASSURANCE SURVEILLANCE PLAN (QASP)

1 INTRODUCTION

This quality assurance surveillance plan (QASP) is pursuant to the requirements listed in the performance work statement (PWS) entitled ATF Mass Notification System. This plan sets forth the procedures and guidelines for ATF Emergency Support Section will use in ensuring the required performance standards or services levels are achieved by the contractor.

1.1 Purpose

- 1.1.1 The purpose of the QASP is to describe the systematic methods used to monitor performance and identify required documentation and resources to be employed. The QASP provides a means for evaluating whether the contractor is meeting the performance standards/quality levels identified in the PWS and the contractor's quality control plan (QCP), and ensure the government pays only for the level of services received.
- 1.1.2 This QASP defines the roles and responsibilities of all members of the integrated project team (IPT), identifies the performance objectives, defines the methodologies used to monitor and evaluate the contractor's performance, describes quality assurance documentation requirements, and describes the analysis of quality assurance monitoring results.

1.2 Performance Management Approach

- 1.2.1 The PWS structures the acquisition around *what* service or quality level is required, as opposed to *how* the contractor should perform the work (i.e., results, not compliance). This QASP will define the performance management approach taken by *<insert name of program/project office or monitoring activity>* to monitor and manage the contractor's performance to ensure the expected outcomes or performance objectives communicated in the PWS are achieved. Performance management rests on developing a capability to review and analyze information generated through performance assessment. The ability to make decisions based on the analysis of performance data is the cornerstone of performance management; this analysis yields information that indicates whether expected outcomes for the project are being achieved by the contractor.
- 1.2.2 Performance management represents a significant shift from the more traditional quality assurance (QA) concepts in several ways. Performance management focuses on assessing whether outcomes are being achieved and to what extent. This approach migrates away from scrutiny of compliance with the processes and practices used to achieve the outcome. A performance-based approach enables the contractor to play a large role in how the work is performed, if the proposed processes are within the stated constraints. The only exceptions to process reviews are those required by law (federal, state, and local) and compelling business situations, such as safety and health. A "results" focus provides the contractor flexibility to continuously improve and innovate over the course of the contract if the critical outcomes expected are being achieved and/or the desired performance levels are being met.

1.3 Performance Management Strategy

- 1.3.1 The contractor is responsible for the quality of all work performed. The contractor measures that quality through the contractor's quality control (QC) program. QC is work output, not workers, and therefore includes all work performed under this contract regardless of whether the work is performed by contractor employees or subcontractors. The contractor's QCP will set forth the staffing and procedures for self-inspecting the quality, timeliness, responsiveness, customer satisfaction, and other performance requirements in the PWS. The contractor will develop and implement a performance management system with processes to assess and report its performance to the designated government representative. The contractor's QCP will also set forth the staffing and procedures for self-inspecting the quality, timeliness, responsiveness, customer satisfaction, and other performance requirements in the PWS. This QASP enables the government to take advantage of the contractor's QC program.
- 1.3.2 The government representative(s) will monitor performance and review performance reports furnished by the contractor to determine how the contractor is performing against communicated performance objectives. The government will make determinations regarding incentives based on performance measurement metric data and notify the contractor of those decisions. The contractor will be responsible for making required changes in processes and practices to ensure performance is managed effectively.

2 ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1 The Contracting Officer (CO)

The CO is responsible for monitoring contract compliance, contract administration, and cost control, and resolving any differences between observations documented by the *<insert title of government authority for performance management: "contracting officer's representative (COR), "administrative contracting officer (ACO)," "quality assurance representative (QAR)," or "program/project manager (PM/PjM)">* and the contractor. The CO will designate one full-time COR as the government authority for performance management. The number of additional representatives serving as technical inspectors depends on the complexity of the services measured, as well as the contractor's performance, and must be identified and designated by the CO.

2.2 The COR

The COR is designated in writing by the CO to act as their authorized representative to assist in administering a contract. COR limitations are contained in the written appointment letter. The COR is responsible for technical administration of the project and ensures proper government surveillance of the contractor's performance. The COR is not empowered to make any contractual commitments or authorize any contractual changes on the government's behalf. Any changes the contractor deems may affect contract price, terms, or conditions must be referred to the CO for action. The COR will have the responsibility for completing QA monitoring forms used to document the inspection and evaluation of the contractor's work performance. Government surveillance may occur under the inspection of services clause for any service relating to the contract.

3 IDENTIFICATION OF REQUIRED PERFORMANCE STANDARDS/QUALITY LEVELS

The required performance standards and/or quality levels are included in the PWS and Attachment 1, Performance Requirements Summary. *[Adjust the following sentences to reflect the instant acquisition:]* If the contractor meets the required service or performance level, it will be paid the monthly amount agreed on in the contract. If the contractor exceeds the service or performance level, it is eligible to receive an incentive or award fee as stated in the contract. Failure to meet the required service or performance level will result in a deduction from the monthly amount.

4 METHODOLOGIES TO MONITOR PERFORMANCE

4.1 Surveillance Techniques

To minimize the performance management burden, simplified surveillance methods shall be used by the government to evaluate contractor performance when appropriate. The primary methods of surveillance are:

- *Random monitoring, which shall be performed by the COR designated inspector*
- *Periodic inspection – the COR typically performs the periodic inspection*

4.2 Customer Feedback

The contractor is expected to establish and maintain professional communication between its employees and customers. The primary objective of this communication is customer satisfaction. Customer satisfaction is the most significant external indicator of the success and effectiveness of all services provided and can be measured through customer complaints.

Performance management drives the contractor to be customer focused through initially and internally addressing customer complaints and investigating the issues and/or problems, but the customer always has the option to communicate complaints to the CO or COR, as opposed to the contractor.

Customer complaints, to be considered valid, must set forth clearly and in writing the detailed nature of the complaint, must be signed, and must be forwarded to the COR. The COR will accept those customer complaints and investigate.

Customer feedback may also be obtained either from the results of formal customer satisfaction surveys or from random customer complaints.

4.3 Acceptable Quality Levels

The acceptable quality levels (AQLs) included in Attachment 1 for contractor performance are structured to allow the contractor to manage how the work is performed while providing negative incentives for performance shortfalls. For certain critical activities, such as those involving life-safety based notifications that may occur at any time, the desired performance level is established at 100 percent. Other levels of performance are keyed to the relative importance of the task to the overall mission performance of ATF and interagency law enforcement partners using the system.

5 QUALITY ASSURANCE DOCUMENTATION

5.1 The Performance Management Feedback Loop

The performance management feedback loop begins with the communication of expected outcomes. Performance standards are expressed in the PWS and assessed using the performance monitoring techniques shown in Attachment 1.

5.2 Monitoring Forms

The government's QA surveillance, accomplished by the COR or supervisors/project coordinators, will be reported using the monitoring form in Attachment 2. The forms, when completed, will document the government's assessment of the contractor's performance under the contract to ensure the required services are being provided.

5.2.1 The COR will retain a copy of all completed QA surveillance forms.

6 ANALYSIS OF QUALITY ASSURANCE ASSESSMENT

6.1 Determining Performance

6.1.1 The government shall use the monitoring methods cited to determine whether the performance standards/service levels/AQLs have been met. If the contractor has not met the minimum requirements, it may be asked to develop a corrective action plan to show how and by what date it intends to bring performance up to the required levels.

6.2 Reporting

6.2.1 At the end of each month, the ESS Planning Section and Joint Support Operations Center will prepare a written report for the ESS Operations Officer (COR) summarizing the overall results of the quality assurance surveillance of the contractor's performance. This report will become part of the QA documentation. It will enable the government to demonstrate whether the contractor is meeting the required performance standards within the agreed upon cost.

6.3 Reviews and Resolution

6.3.1 The COR may require the contractor's designated alternate to meet with the COR as deemed necessary to discuss the performance evaluation. The COR will define a frequency of in-depth reviews with the contractor, including appropriate self-assessments by the contractor; however, if the need arises, the contractor will meet with the COR as often as required or per the contractor's request. The agenda of the reviews may include:

- Monthly performance assessment data and trend analysis
- Issues and concerns of both parties
- Any corrective action analysis or required plan
- Recommendations for improved efficiency and/or effectiveness.

6.3.2 The QAR must coordinate and communicate with the contractor to resolve issues and concerns regarding marginal or unacceptable performance.

6.3.3 The COR and contractor should jointly communicate and formulate tactical and long-term plans and courses of action to ensure proper functioning of the contract. Changes to service levels or metrics will be incorporated as a contract modification at the convenience of the procuring CO.

ATTACHMENT 1: PERFORMANCE REQUIREMENTS SUMMARY

Required Services (Task)	Performance Standards	Acceptable Quality Levels	Methods of Surveillance	Incentive (Positive and/or Negative) (Impact on Contractor Payments)
Must provide rapid capability to send mass messages using a multi-modal messaging platform to include landline and cellular phone (recorded voice, text to speech), SMS Short and Long Code SMS and MMS messages, and email, and social media.	Provision the services described in the PWS and the capability to delivery emergency and routine messages in accordance with the urgency of the message being sent as described in the PWS. E	The COR will consistently monitor and review the contractors delivery of messaging, interaction with the government users of the system, and consult with government personnel to ensure a fair evaluation with regard to the contractor's timely delivery of messaging services is provided in accordance with the PWS.	Periodic Monitoring, Periodic Inspection	The CO/COR will record the contractor's performance in CPARS (positive and negative). The CO may also terminate this contract vehicle if the contractor fails to meet the requirements of this PWS.
The Mass Notification System maintains two separate databases to support the SOD Operational	Provision the services described in the PWS and the capability to delivery emergency and	The COR will consistently monitor and review the contractors delivery of messaging,	<i>Periodic Monitoring, Periodic Inspection</i>	The CO/COR will record the contractor's performance in CPARS (positive and negative). The CO may also terminate this contract vehicle

needs and the Federal Firearms Alerts in distinct and separate instances of the system.	routine messages in accordance with the urgency of the message being sent as described in the PWS.	interaction with the government users of the system, and consult with government personnel to ensure a fair evaluation with regard to the contractor's timely delivery of messaging services is provided in accordance with the PWS.		if the contractor fails to meet the requirements of this PWS.
The system is available on a 24-hour a day, 7 days a week, and 365 days per year.	Provision the services described in the PWS and the capability to delivery emergency and routine messages in accordance with the urgency of the message being sent as described in the PWS.	The COR will consistently monitor and review the contractors delivery of messaging, interaction with the government users of the system, and consult with government personnel to ensure a fair evaluation with regard to the contractor's timely delivery of messaging services is	<i>Periodic Monitoring, Periodic Inspection</i>	The CO/COR will record the contractor's performance in CPARS (positive and negative). The CO may also terminate this contract vehicle if the contractor fails to meet the requirements of this PWS.

		provided in accordance with the PWS.		
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ATTACHMENT 2: SAMPLE QUALITY ASSURANCE MONITORING FORM

SERVICE or STANDARD: This is a service and must meet the requirements in the PWS.

SURVEY PERIOD: Date is TBD- Base plus 4 Options Years is proposed.

SURVEILLANCE METHOD (check):

☐ Random Sampling ☐ 100% Inspection ☐ Periodic Inspection ☐ Customer Complaint

LEVEL OF SURVEILLANCE (check):

☐ Monthly ☐ Quarterly ☐ As needed

PERCENTAGE OF ITEMS SAMPLED DURING SURVEY PERIOD: N/A %

ANALYSIS OF RESULTS:

Observed Service Provider Performance Measurement Rate: 100 %

Service Provider's Performance (check): ☐ Meets Standards
☐ Does Not Meet Standards

Narrative of Performance During Survey Period: _____

PREPARED BY: _____ **DATE:** _____